Standard Precautions and Sharps Injury Response

Synthetic educational example | Not clinical, legal, or operational guidance

Document ID: DEMO-IC-001

Owner: Infection Prevention Team

Status: Synthetic training example

Review interval: 12 months

Purpose

This example policy describes a basic workflow for reducing avoidable exposure to blood and body fluids. It is fictional demonstration content, not a clinical protocol. A real facility must replace it with approved local procedures.

Standard precautions

Staff should perform hand hygiene at the required points of care, select personal protective equipment based on the anticipated exposure, and dispose of sharps immediately in approved puncture-resistant containers. Used needles must not be routinely recapped, bent, or separated by hand. Reusable equipment must follow the facility's validated cleaning and reprocessing procedure.

Sharps injury response

After a suspected sharps injury, stop the task safely, perform the locally approved first aid, and promptly contact the designated occupational-health or emergency pathway. Report the incident through the facility's incident reporting process. Clinical evaluation, testing, and any post-exposure intervention must be determined by qualified clinicians using current facility policy and applicable guidance.

Training and acknowledgment

Relevant clinical staff must read the currently approved version and record acknowledgment in DocuGuard. Acknowledgment confirms that the staff member has read the policy; it does not replace training, competency assessment, or clinical judgment.

Review and ownership

The Infection Prevention Team should review this policy after a significant incident, a relevant guideline change, or at the scheduled review date. The document owner must ensure that superseded copies are not used.

Search terms

standard precautions, sharps injury, hand hygiene, PPE, exposure, infection prevention, incident reporting